increased to two hundred and eighty, by a fund provided by the munificence of General De Betskoi, the enlightened and liberal head and director-general of this, and all the other institutions of the same kind established by her Imperial Majesty.

The principal regulations for conducting this institution are the following:

The children are admitted between five and six years of age, and continued on the establishment twelve years. They are divided into classes according to their ages, four of nobles with fifty in each class, and four of commoners with seventy in each class. In every third year on 21 April (the birthday of the Empress), fifty children of the nobility, and seventy of commoners are taken in, to replace the same numbers discharged.

Before they rise every morning, the windows of the rooms are thrown open to purify them with fresh air.

The first class (dressed in brown, and consisting of children of the youngest ages), rise at seven in winter, and at six in summer. After being washed and attending prayers, they are taken into the garden where they breakfast, and play about in the coldest weather till nine. During their first year, each of them is allowed for breakfast, a small loaf of white bread, and a glass of milk and water; but after their first year, they are allowed no other drink than water. At nine they are called back to the house, and from this hour to eleven are employed in learning the French and Russian languages, and in knitting, sewing, etc., but care is taken to render all the instruction they receive agreeable, nothing being taught in this establishment by compulsion. Twice in the week they receive lessons in dancing; and this is a part of education common to all the classes, and never discontinued, because reckoned conducive to health. After eleven they return to their play in the garden, where they continue till noon, at which time they are called to dinner, which consists of soup, vegetables, etc. For some months at first they are allowed meat; but they are gradually weaned from it, till at last, while in this and the next class, it comes to be entirely withheld from them except in soups, in order to cure them of some cutaneous distempers to which at this age they are subject, and also to prepare them for passing with less danger through the whooping-cough, measles and smallpox. After dinner they return to the garden, and at four, have a repast similar to that in the morning, viz. a loaf of bread and a glass of water. Here they continue to divert themselves till at seven they are called to supper, which consists

in winter of dried fruit, milk, and grain; and in summer of preparations of milk, and some provisions from the garden. It may be proper to add, that they read and write standing, and are not allowed to sit down, except to needlework. In consequence of this management, and of living so much in the air, and being used to exercise, and cleanliness and a simple diet, they are seldom known to take cold; and become capable of bearing the severest weather of the climate without receiving any harm, their clothing being only a short wadded cloak, whilst others are loaded with furs.

The second class (dressed in blue) enter it about eight years of age, and are obliged to apply more closely to writing, drawing, dancing, etc.

The third class (dressed in grey) enter it at eleven or twelve years of age. They rise at five, in the summer, and six in winter; but are called to the house (after breakfasting in the garden), an hour sooner than the children in the first and second classes; because more time is wanted for instructing and improving them. They are now taught (besides drawing, dancing, turning,[1] needlework, etc.) vocal and instrumental music. They are allowed a ball and concert every week; and a taste for books is inspired, by putting them upon copying and reciting select passages from the best authors.

The fourth class (dressed in white) enter it at fourteen or fifteen years of age. They are taught tambour-work, housekeeping, the management of a family, etc., and initiated into history, geography, and natural philosophy. In order to acquire a just elocution, and to exercise themselves in politeness, and vocal and instrumental music, they occasionally give balls and little operas to company from Petersburg.

The children of the nobility are distinguished from the children of commoners, only by wearing a finer camlet of the colours appropriated to the different classes; and as far as diet, exercise, regimen, etc., are concerned, the method of managing them is the same; but the instruction given the latter, is confined to needlework, reading, housekeeping and such other occupations and improvements as are suitable to the humbler walks of life, for which they are intended.

The children on this foundation enjoy, as might be expected, an uncommon degree of health. Of fifty-one children of nobility admitted in 1764, and fifty admitted in 1767, and

[1] I was obliged to the ladies for a very curious piece of their work in ivory, which was presented to me on my visit to this house.